CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 8

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- reviewing a car
- choosing a car
- maintaining a car
- repairing a car

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- several years
- a few days
- a decade
- several hours

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- fix the headlights
- replace the battery
- change the oil
- turn everything off

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- to bring some special cables
- to move it closer to the man's
- to check if she can start it
- to recharge the battery in it

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- turn off the car
- fill up with gas
- wait for a while
- buy a new battery

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

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Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- He values car mechanics' advice.
- He knows a lot about automobiles.
- He has had many car problems.
- He wants to be a car mechanic.

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- teaching children about cars
- learning about how engines work
- avoiding online information
- being prepared for emergencies

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- what the woman has been doing for fun
- how to find the time for fun activities
- when to attend a play at the theatre
- what activities they should do together

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- She has been working overtime a lot.
- She hasn't been able to afford it.
- She has been busy with daily life.
- She has been waiting for a companion.

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- He is enthusiastic.
- He is surprised.
- He is grateful.
- He is uninterested.

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- She prefers outdoor activities.
- She is interested in many things.
- She wants to do something every day.
- She is willing to spend lots of money.

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- with a plan of action
- with a surprise problem
- with a new purchase
- with a final decision

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- a bank
- a call centre
- an HR office
- an accounting firm

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- advice on giving better customer service
- help in understanding the questions
- suggestions on how to please the manager
- tips for remembering people's names

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- He created the form.
- He has worked there longer.
- He is the manager.
- He passed his probation.

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- evaluating herself
- giving useful advice
- providing quick service
- remembering names

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- Choosing high ratings is risky.
- Exceptional work needs immediate recognition.
- Lower rankings suggest limited skill.
- Problems need to be discussed beforehand.

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- She asked everyone for suggestions.
- She trusts the manager's feedback.
- She passed her probation recently.
- She can redo her review afterwards.

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. Camaro found out about straw houses from _____
- ◯ a magazine.
- ◯ a local company.
- ◯ area residents.
- ◯ a news broadcast.

2. Camaro's house was built _____
- ◯ by local friends.
- ◯ in less than a year.
- ◯ with great difficulty.
- ◯ in the town centre.

3. The story is about _____
- ◯ an unlikely problem.
- ◯ puzzling research.
- ◯ surprising consequences.
- ◯ an unusual solution.

4. Straw bale houses are _____
- ◯ more energy efficient than other houses.
- ◯ not as sturdy as other houses.
- ◯ cheaper to construct than other houses.
- ◯ not as attractive as other houses.

5. Camaro's decision was motivated by _____
- ◯ living in a small trailer.
- ◯ increased heating costs.
- ◯ the size of her property.
- ◯ the company's ads.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. What is the purpose of the meeting?
- ◯ to make a training decision
- ◯ to discuss staff performance
- ◯ to re-evaluate staff roles
- ◯ to compare training formats

2. What will the training seminar cover?
- ◯ how to effectively teach your colleagues
- ◯ how to use new accounting software
- ◯ how to write good business policies
- ◯ how to describe complicated procedures

3. Why does Benjamin suggest Diane?
- ◯ She is available on weekends.
- ◯ She has been there the longest.
- ◯ She deserves a trip to Vancouver.
- ◯ She needs to learn about accounting.

4. What does Ian think about Diane?
- ◯ She is being dishonest about her overtime.
- ◯ She does not require more compensation now.
- ◯ She is lacking in teaching and accounting skills.
- ◯ She will not want to work on another weekend.

5. Why does Ian think Beth is a good teacher?
- ◯ She has given in-house seminars.
- ◯ People have told him she is a good teacher.
- ◯ She has a degree in education.
- ◯ Ian has always found Beth's instructions helpful.

6. What does Jennifer likely believe?
- ◯ People can change their work habits easily.
- ◯ People shouldn't complain as much as they do.
- ◯ People can learn to explain things more clearly.
- ◯ People shouldn't believe everything they hear.

PART 5

7. What do they agree to do?

- ◯ delay making a final decision
- ◯ speak to all three candidates
- ◯ review the candidates' education
- ◯ consult the procedures manual

8. What is true of the training seminar in Vancouver?

- ◯ It will be held at Head Office.
- ◯ They need to register for it tomorrow.
- ◯ It is at least 2 weeks away.
- ◯ They need to read materials beforehand.

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. The radio program talks about whether schools should _____

- ◯ monitor students' use of social media.
- ◯ develop lessons based on social media.
- ◯ offer classes on how to use social media.
- ◯ train more teachers to use social media.

2. LAB-Tech Industries _____

- ◯ develops social networking platforms for schools.
- ◯ boosts employee productivity by offering incentives.
- ◯ prefers individuals who are able to work independently.
- ◯ considers social networking a technological skill.

3. Teacher James Spadoni finds it challenging to _____

- ◯ incorporate new technology into his classes.
- ◯ get students to participate during group work.
- ◯ keep students from surfing the internet in class.
- ◯ organize interesting computer class projects.

4. Parent Mandy Rainer believes _____

- ◯ computers should be removed from schools.
- ◯ over-connectedness negatively impacts learning.
- ◯ schools ignore the value of communication skills.
- ◯ schools should prepare students for the workforce.

5. Spadoni and LAB-Tech would agree that _____

- ◯ online socializing results in reduced productivity.
- ◯ children learn new things easier than adults.
- ◯ schools must keep pace with changes in society.
- ◯ group work can be challenging for shy individuals.

6. LAB-Tech would likely prefer an employee who _____

- ◯ likes working alone.
- ◯ works best independently.
- ◯ enjoys group projects.
- ◯ is extremely competitive.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	repairing a car
Question 2	several years
Question 3	turn everything off
Question 4	to move it closer to the man's
Question 5	wait for a while
Question 6	
Question 7	He values car mechanics' advice.
Question 8	being prepared for emergencies

PART 2	
Question 1	what activities they should do together
Question 2	She has been busy with daily life.
Question 3	He is enthusiastic.
Question 4	She is interested in many things.
Question 5	with a plan of action

PART 3	
Question 1	a bank
Question 2	help in understanding the questions
Question 3	He has worked there longer.
Question 4	remembering names
Question 5	Problems need to be discussed beforehand.
Question 6	She passed her probation recently.

PART 4	
Question 1	a magazine.
Question 2	in less than a year.
Question 3	an unusual solution.
Question 4	more energy efficient than other houses.
Question 5	increased heating costs.

PART 5	
Question 1	to make a training decision
Question 2	how to use new accounting software
Question 3	She deserves a trip to Vancouver.
Question 4	She does not require more compensation now.
Question 5	Ian has always found Beth's instructions helpful.
Question 6	People shouldn't believe everything they hear.
Question 7	delay making a final decision
Question 8	It is at least 2 weeks away.

PART 6	
Question 1	develop lessons based on social media.
Question 2	considers social networking a technological skill.
Question 3	incorporate new technology into his classes.
Question 4	over-connectedness negatively impacts learning.
Question 5	schools must keep pace with changes in society.
Question 6	enjoys group projects.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman on a street next to some shops. The man is looking at his car and the woman is parked nearby.

Section 1:

WOMAN: Hey there, are you having some trouble with your car?

MAN: Yeah, it won't start.

WOMAN: Maybe I could take a quick look at it for you.

MAN: Well . . . I don't want to bother you.

WOMAN: Really, it's no bother. I'm just meeting with two friends from work a bit later. Let's see. Your oil seems fine and you have enough gas. How long have you been parked here? Did you leave anything on?

MAN: For the last several hours—actually, from eight this morning. Other than my front lights, I turned everything off. It's strange; I've never had problems with this car since I bought it five years ago.

WOMAN: Alright, I think I know what your problem is. Since you left your front lights on, the car battery is now dead. The good news is that this is an easy problem to fix.

MAN: Really! That's great because I don't want to be late for a very important meeting—it's with my son's teacher.

Now answer questions 1-3.

1. What is this conversation about?
2. How long has the man owned his car?
3. What did the man forget to do?

Section 2:

WOMAN: I have some special cables called jumper cables that will join our car batteries together. When I start my car, electricity from my battery will travel to your battery.

MAN: Really? And that should be enough to get my car going again?

WOMAN: Hopefully. First, I'll drive my car over here so our cars are facing each other. That way, the cars will be close enough for me to connect the cables.

MAN: Cool! I'm interested to see how this works.

WOMAN: Alright, I've connected the cables, now start your car.

MAN: Okay, let's hope this works! Wow, it started! How did you know what to do?

WOMAN: Working on cars is my job. I'm a mechanic. Now just leave your car running for at least 15 minutes so your car's battery has enough time to recharge. You can either wait at the gas station parking lot over there or start driving.

MAN: Okay, great!

Now answer questions 4-5.

4. Why does the woman have to drive her car?
5. What will the man most likely do next?

Transcripts

Section 3:

MAN: You know, my son wants to be a mechanic. He'll be excited to hear that a real mechanic helped me. He's a smart little guy.

WOMAN: Hm, that's nice to hear. Tell him it's a fun job.

MAN: I will. Now I need to get myself some jumper cables. And in case something else breaks down, are there some things you suggest I keep in my car? Maybe a repair manual, a gas can, some wiper fluid?

WOMAN: Those are all good things to have in your car. But most importantly, you should make sure you have a spare tire and some basic tools to change it. You can also go online and make your own list.

MAN: Sounds good. Oh, look at the time! I need to be at school soon. Thank you so much for your help.

WOMAN: You're welcome!

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. Which item does the woman think is most important?
7. What is likely true about the man?
8. What does the woman recommend?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a conversation between two friends, a man and a woman.

MAN: Hey, Amber, I haven't seen you for a while! How are you?

WOMAN: Actually, I was just thinking about that very thing—and I'm good: I have a good job, I have a good apartment, I've managed to figure out all the day-to-day things, but you know? I've been here six months now, and I haven't really seen anything! I mean, I haven't taken the time to see the city—I wish I were more organized with my time, and . . . I was wondering if you'd like to help me.

MAN: Help you see the city? Yes, of course, I'd love to do that! What would you like to see?

WOMAN: Well, I'm not sure. I mean, I don't really know what my options are.

MAN: Okay . . . are you interested in arts and culture? We could go to art galleries and museums. Or we could go to a dance performance or see something at the theatre.

WOMAN: Well, I do like to dance—

MAN: So you want to do something rather than just see something? Okay, there are dance clubs, dance classes—or we could go hiking in the mountains or cycling on the islands. There's so much we could do!

WOMAN: I don't know how to choose—I suspect some things cost more than others. And certainly we should wait for good weather for the outdoor things. As for the arts and culture options, I guess it depends on what plays are being performed at the theatres . . .

MAN: Okay, I have an idea. There are a couple of excellent newspapers that list virtually everything there is to do and see in any given week. Why don't we get this week's issues and take a look?

WOMAN: Oh, that sounds like a perfect solution! And if you're willing, maybe we can do something different each week. Because I don't think I'm going to be able to choose just one thing!

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. What are the man and the woman discussing?
2. Why hasn't the woman seen much of the city?
3. What is the man's response to her invitation?
4. What is true of the woman?
5. How does the conversation end?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation between two employees. The woman is asking the man about something at their workplace.

WOMAN: Ali, can you help me understand this job performance form? I've never done one of these before.

MAN: Sure, Faizeh. What would you like to know?

WOMAN: Well, the first question asks for a brief outline of significant accomplishments throughout the year, indicating why each accomplishment deserves special recognition. What is a "significant accomplishment"? Can you give me an example?

MAN: It's something special you've done. It's something over and above what you do on a day-to-day basis, something outside your job description. For example, at the bank we pretty much guarantee excellent customer service, but perhaps you do more than that. I bet you know many of your customers' names, right? And call each one by name.

WOMAN: Of course. Don't you?

MAN: I try, but I find it hard. So this is a significant accomplishment, being able to greet each person by name before they give you their bank card.

WOMAN: OK, I understand that one. Now, next question. There are sections about interaction with colleagues, responsibility, accountability, and so on. And we have to rate ourselves in each section by choosing one of four options: exceptionally well, very well, well enough, or not very well. How do we do this? If I choose too high, the manager will think I'm arrogant and over-confident. If I choose too low, she'll think I don't have enough ability or skill.

MAN: Yeah, this is a hard one. I usually rate myself "very well" for most of them, and perhaps one or two "exceptionally well" if I have good reasons.

WOMAN: So you don't choose the two lower rankings for anything?

MAN: That's right. I would hope that the manager would talk to me before performance evaluation time to discuss any poor performance she saw in my work. That kind of thing should be discussed when it happens.

WOMAN: That's a good point. I'll take your advice and choose the "very well" descriptor for everything. I haven't been here long enough to be exceptional. I passed my probation period a few months ago, so I should be safe with these choices.

MAN: That's a good way to describe it, as safe. The manager's great at discussing your self-ratings, so don't worry too much about it.

WOMAN: OK, thanks for your help.

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. Where do the man and woman work?
2. What does the woman want from the man?
3. Why can the man answer the woman's questions?
4. What does the man think the woman excels at?
5. On what basis does the man make his choices?
6. Why does the woman feel safe with her choices?

PART 4

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news story about building a house.

Area resident Beverley Camaro has built a house of straw.

Camaro moved into the area last year, and had been living in a trailer on a small plot of land in the countryside on which she intended to build a small house. Concerned about growing heating costs and increasingly colder winter temperatures, she spent a month researching heating and housing construction. She then came across an article about straw houses in a magazine. A few weeks later, she discovered a company that specializes in such construction. Six months later, she moved into her new house, made of straw.

Camaro explains that the house is just insulated with straw and many people have misconceptions about straw houses. For example, they are not more susceptible to fire than other homes. Although loose straw can be burned, the straw bales used in house construction are so compressed that there isn't enough oxygen in them to burn. What's more, straw bale houses are waterproof, according to Camaro, because the sturdy walls are plastered inside and out. Hers, she explained, are a lovely amber colour. The most important, due to the superior insulation value of straw, Camaro anticipates lower heating bills.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion among three business associates, two men and one woman. They are meeting at their office.

Benjamin: So we have to figure out who to send to the training seminar in August. Any ideas?

Jennifer: Well, Cheryl is the one who will be using the new accounting software the most. I think we should send her.

Ian: But there will be others here who will need to use it as well, and Beth is a better teacher. If we send her, she'll be able to hold in-house training sessions, and we'll all be able to use it. It's not enough just to bring back the materials. What do you think?

Benjamin: Actually, I was going to suggest we send Diane. She's worked almost every weekend last month. That's a lot of overtime. I think she's entitled to a weekend in Vancouver!

Jennifer: But training seminars shouldn't be considered holidays. If we want to reward Diane for her overtime, we should do it another way.

Ian: I agree about the training seminars. Also, yes, Diane did work a lot of overtime, but she did get paid for it. Isn't that reward enough?

Benjamin: I suppose so. Okay, so it's between Cheryl and Beth? Ian, what makes you say that Beth is the better teacher?

Ian: Well, whenever I have problems with any of the programs I'm using, I go to Beth for help, and she helps. She's very good at explaining things.

Jennifer: That might be true. But you've never gone to Cheryl—how do you know she's not just as good at explaining things?

Ian: People talk. Complain.

Jennifer: Ian! You know better than that! I believe Cheryl has a degree in education—she would be a good choice!

Benjamin: It is true that Cheryl's never given any of our in-house seminars. Beth has. Why don't we explain to Cheryl that we'll base the decision off teaching skills, and if she can prove to us that she can pass the information along, we'll send her to Vancouver.

Ian: That sounds fair. We'll set up a training session for Cheryl to conduct. If she does a good job, she'll get my vote. As you say, she will be the one using the accounting software the most.

Jennifer: But what will we ask Cheryl to teach us? Oh, I know! Head Office just sent a new policies and procedures manual. She could choose something . . .

Benjamin: Yeah! I'll let her know tomorrow, and I bet she can figure something out in the next two weeks.

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about using social networking sites in schools.

Today on Chat Radio: Should online social networking sites, such as Facebook or Twitter, be used in schools? Social networking sites, where users share messages, pictures, or videos with others, are an increasingly popular form of communication for both adults and children. In an effort to keep education relevant, many are asking whether such sites should, perhaps, be incorporated into school curricula.

For Sheena Bradley, CEO of LAB-Tech Industries, this question is easily answered. She argues that education is meant to prepare students for their future which will likely involve working with others via online platforms. For example, LAB-Tech uses an in-house social networking site called ThinkTank to encourage employee collaboration and the development of new ideas, something that has led to a substantial increase in productivity and innovation among employees. For Bradley, we are at the dawn of a new work culture where the innovative group is valued. Accordingly, she sees online social networking as a popular medium for acquiring the skills that today's employers want: technological knowledge and the ability to work with others.

James Spadoni, a teacher at Crestview Secondary, agrees. However, while Spadoni is clear that online social networking should be incorporated into the curriculum, how to achieve this is less clear for him. Spadoni, being someone nearing sixty, did not grow up using computers. He thus struggles to learn how new technologies can be used to attain a pedagogical goal. Despite this challenge, Spadoni has found online social networking to be quite successful in the classroom. As part of last year's final class project, Spadoni's class used Twitter to share ideas and organize workflow. This proved particularly effective for shyer students who tended to feel more comfortable sharing ideas in an online environment.

Mandy Rainer, however, is not convinced. She wants her children to be learning at school, not playing around on the internet. She sees no need to include online social networking as part of the school curriculum, insisting that students already get enough exposure outside of school. For Rainer, who already struggles to get her kids off Facebook, children need less socializing, not more. Children need to learn to concentrate, to focus on a task, and to read without distraction. It's Rainer's opinion that social media and teamwork certainly won't help students write their own research essays. To prepare for university and many professional careers, they must be able to work independently and rely on themselves.

Many parent groups agree with Rainer and would like to see social media and cellphones banned in the classroom. What do our listeners think? Call us and share your opinion.